THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 10 — ENGLISH FULL SYLLABUS PAPER SET 08

Reading · Writing & Grammar · Literature (First Flight, Poetry, Footprints Without Feet) | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 3 Hours 15 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 80**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A (Reading, 20 marks): Q. 1–2, passages with 10 sub-questions each (1 mark each).
3. Section B (Writing, 12 marks): Q. 3 Notice (3), Q. 4 Letter (5), Q. 5 Analytical paragraph (4).
4. Section C (Grammar, 8 marks): Q. 6–13 (1 mark each).
5. Section D–G (Literature, 40 marks): Q. 14–21 objective (1 mark each), Q. 22–24 extract-based (4 marks each), Q. 25–28 short answer (2 marks each), Q. 29–32 long answer (3 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 3, 4, 5 and Q. 29 to 32.
7. Write the question number before each answer.

SECTION — A (Reading: 20 Marks) — 20 Marks

Read the passages and answer the questions that follow.

1. *Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* **10**

In many schools the period for games is the first to be cancelled when the syllabus runs behind. Teachers exchange a worried look, a notice is read out, and the playground is left to the dust. The assumption is that sport is a luxury and mathematics is a necessity. It is worth asking whether this is really true.

Consider what happens on a hockey field. A player must watch the ball, the opponents and her own teammates at the same time. She must decide in a second whether to pass or to run. If her team loses she must, within minutes, shake hands and go back to the game. A hundred such small decisions teach patience, judgement and good temper in a way no lecture can.

Sport also teaches a kind of honesty. On the field, a player's skill cannot be hidden behind a long answer. Either the ball goes in or it does not. Players learn to accept the result, to find out why they lost and to practise until they improve. This habit of honest practice is exactly what a student needs for studies.

The body, too, has its claim. Children who play for an hour a day sleep better, concentrate longer and fall ill less often. Several studies have found that students who exercise regularly perform as well as their classmates in examinations, though they spend fewer hours at their desks. A cancelled games period saves time on paper but takes it back in tiredness. The sensible school keeps the playground open, for it is also a classroom with a larger roof.

(i) The writer begins by pointing out that in many schools: **1**

(a) the playground is crowded **(b)** games periods are cancelled first
(c) teachers play with students **(d)** games are compulsory

(ii) The hockey example shows that sport teaches: **1**

(a) quick judgement and good temper **(b)** only physical strength
(c) only discipline **(d)** how to defeat others

(iii) 'Sport teaches a kind of honesty' because: **1**

(a) rules are strict **(b)** on the field skill cannot be hidden
(c) players never lie **(d)** umpires are strict

(iv) Children who play for an hour daily: **1**

(a) sleep better and fall ill less often **(b)** score less
(c) become lazy **(d)** forget lessons

(v) 'A classroom with a larger roof' means: **1**

(a) the sky **(b)** a library
(c) a hall **(d)** the playground

(vi) Why is sport treated as a luxury in some schools? 1

(vii) What must a hockey player do at the same time? 1

(viii) What habit learned from sport is useful for studies? 1

(ix) Find a word in the passage which means 'something not necessary but pleasant'. 1

(x) Find a word in the passage which means 'the ability to decide wisely'. 1

2. *Read the following case and answer the questions that follow.* 10

The Sports Committee of a school recorded the number of students participating in four games and the number of medals won by the school in the last inter-school meet.

Game	Students participating	Medals won
Kabaddi	24	5
Athletics	30	8
Volleyball	18	2
Badminton	12	4

(i) Which game had the most participants? 1

(a) Volleyball **(b)** Badminton **(c)** Athletics **(d)** Kabaddi

(ii) In which game were the fewest medals won? 1

(a) Badminton **(b)** Volleyball **(c)** Athletics **(d)** Kabaddi

(iii) How many medals did the school win in all? 1

(a) 19 **(b)** 21 **(c)** 15 **(d)** 17

(iv) How many students took part in all the games? 1

(v) Which game gave the highest number of medals? 1

(vi) Which game had the best ratio of medals to participants? 1

(vii) How many more students took part in Athletics than in Badminton? 1

(viii) Suggest one way to improve results in volleyball. 1

(ix) What does the data suggest about the school's performance? 1

(x) Find a word in the passage which means 'a gathering for competitions'. 1

SECTION — B (Writing Skills: 12 Marks) — 12 Marks

Internal choice is given in each question.

3. Your school is going to hold an Inter-House Debate Competition. Write a notice in not more than 50 words giving all details. You are Neha/Nitin, the Cultural Secretary. 3

OR

Your school library has received a set of new books. Write a notice in not more than 50 words informing students about it. You are the Librarian. 3

4. You are Sachin/Sarika of 8, Subhash Marg, Kota. Write a letter to the Principal of your school, in about 120 words, requesting permission to attend a state-level badminton tournament for three days. 5

OR

You are Kiran/Karan. Write a letter to your younger brother/sister, in about 120 words, advising him/her to take studies seriously and to develop good habits. 5

5. Write a paragraph in about 100 words on 'Save Water, Save Life'. 4

OR

Write a paragraph in about 100 words on 'The Advantages of Early Rising'. 4

SECTION — C (Grammar: 8 Marks) — 8 Marks

Attempt all the questions.

6. Fill in the blank with the correct tense: When I reached the station, the train _____ (leave). 1

7. Choose the correct modal: _____ I borrow your pen? (Shall / May / Must) 1

8. Fill in the blank with the right article: She is _____ honest girl. 1

9. Rewrite in reported speech: He said, "I am writing a letter." 1

10. Change into active voice: The window was broken by the boys. 1

11. Join using 'although': He was tired. He went on working. 1

12. Find and correct the error: Each of the boys have finished the work. 1

13. Rearrange to form a meaningful sentence: has / the / begun / examination / week / this 1

SECTION — D (Literature: Objective Type) — 8 Marks

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

14. Lomov's real purpose was to: 1

(a) buy Squeezer **(b)** invite Chubukov to a hunt
(c) ask for Natalya's hand in marriage **(d)** claim the Oxen Meadows

15. Lencho wrote the letter on: 1

(a) Monday **(b)** Sunday **(c)** Friday **(d)** Saturday

16. 10 May is described as an 'autumn day' because: 1

(a) it was a cold day
(b) it is near the equator
(c) South Africa lies in the southern hemisphere
(d) leaves fell that day

17. Belinda's kitten was named: 1

(a) Custard **(b)** Blink **(c)** Mustard **(d)** Ink

18. The young man says that no young man can love Anne for herself alone because of her: 1

(a) wealth **(b)** name **(c)** beauty of voice **(d)** yellow hair

19. The Historian uses a device called: 1

(a) historiscope **(b)** telescope **(c)** microscope **(d)** periscope

20. Tricki's only fault, according to the narrator, was: 1

(a) disobedience **(b)** bad temper **(c)** greed **(d)** laziness

21. Why did the thief take a new name each month? 1

(a) To keep ahead of the police and former employers
(b) He forgot names
(c) Anil asked him to
(d) He liked change

SECTION — E (Literature: Extract-based Questions) — 12 Marks

Read the extracts and answer the questions that follow.

22. *Read the following extract and answer the questions that follow.* 4

> The air display that followed was not only a show of precision and military strength. It showed that the army and police now stood loyal to a government that had been freely elected. Only moments earlier the generals, their chests covered with medals from older days, had saluted the new President, though not many years before they would have arrested him. He was fully aware of this change.

(i) What was the air display a demonstration of? 1

(ii) How had the attitude of the generals changed? 1

(iii) Which aircraft left a smoke trail in the colours of the new flag? 1

(iv) Find the word in the passage that means 'colourful and impressive'. 1

23. *Read the following extract and answer the questions that follow.* 4

> Frost then imagines that the world might have to perish twice. In that case, he says, his knowledge of hate tells him that ice would be great for destruction and would suffice. Ice represents cold feeling, a lack of compassion.

(i) What condition does the poet suggest? 1

(ii) What does he know enough of? 1

(iii) What does ice stand for? 1

(iv) What is the word 'suffice' used for? 1

24. *Read the following extract and answer the questions that follow.* 4

> Mr Herriot was shocked at Tricki's appearance. The little dog had become hugely fat and stood with bloodshot, watery eyes staring ahead, his tongue hanging out. His mistress explained that she had been feeding him extra malt, cod-liver oil and a bowl of Horlicks because she thought he was weak. She could not bear to refuse him cream cakes and chocolates.

(i) How did Tricki look? 1

(ii) What did Mrs Pumphrey feed him? 1

(iii) Why did she give him so much food? 1

(iv) What does this show about her? 1

SECTION — F (Literature: Short Answer Type) — 8 Marks

Answer in about 30–40 words each.

25. What does Anne's 'brief sketch' of her life tell us about Kitty's role? 2

26. Describe Mij's first meeting with Maxwell. 2

27. How does the poet suggest we identify a lion and a tiger? 2

28. How was Ausable different from Fowler's idea of a secret agent? 2

SECTION — G (Literature: Long Answer Type) — 12 Marks

Answer in about 80–100 words each.

29. Describe the second quarrel between Lomov and Natalya. 3

OR

What adventure activities and attractions does Coorg offer to a tourist? 3

30. Compare the thief's attitude to education at the beginning and at the end. 3

OR

Describe Ebright's discovery and theory. 3

31. What are the two sides of Valli's journey — joy and sorrow? 3

OR

Narrate the events at the ball and after it. 3

32. Describe how Custard proved his bravery. 3

OR

Compare the tiger in the zoo and the tiger in the jungle as shown in the poem. 3

END OF QUESTION PAPER — **Total: 80 Marks**